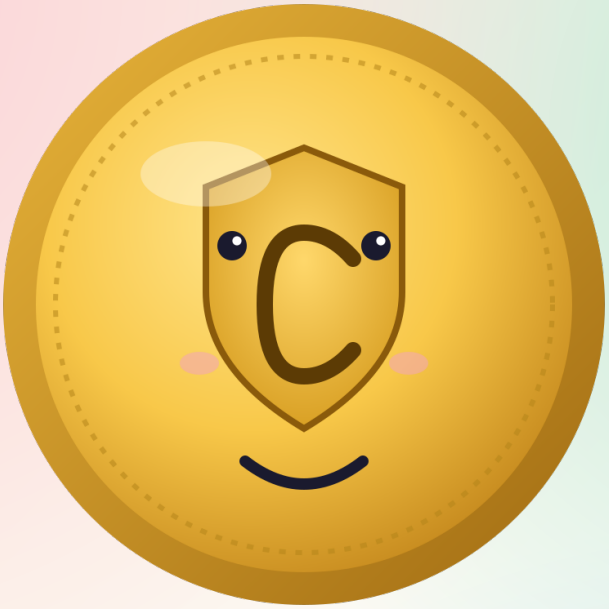


GRADE K

Lesson Plans

C A S H

Businesses help people.

Ten lessons that bring the year to life.

Grade K — Cash to Company: Lesson Plans

Ten short lessons, sampled across the year. Each lesson is 25–30 minutes — about half the length of a middle-school period. Each is built around movement, picture-first thinking, dramatic play, and oral response. Most assessment is **observation-based**: the teacher notes who can do what on a class checklist. Worksheets are minimal and mostly drawing.

The format below is the pattern for every lesson:

- **Objectives** (what a child can demonstrably do)
- **Standards** (one or two; copied from the Standards Alignment Map)
- **Materials**
- **Vocabulary** (1–3 words)
- **Procedure** (warm-up, mini-lesson, dramatic play / activity, close)
- **Differentiation** (ELL, IEP/504, advanced)
- **Assessment** (what the teacher watches for, recorded on the class checklist)

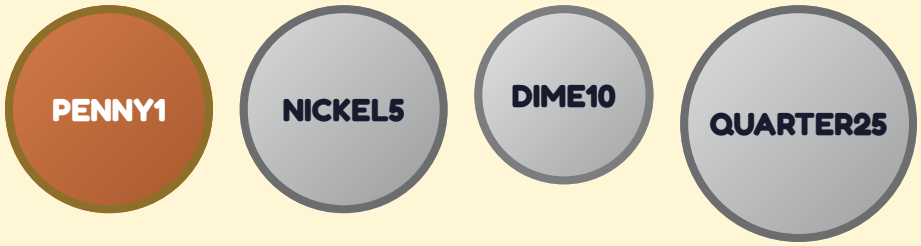
Lessons sampled:

1. (Week 1, Unit 1) Who helped you today? — Cash V1 launch
2. (Week 4, Unit 1) The Helpers Wall — building the bulletin board

3. (Week 7, Unit 1) Match the sign to the helper
4. (Week 10, Unit 2) Meet the four coins — Cash V3 launch
5. (Week 14, Unit 2) Which coin is more? — pair-up game
6. (Week 19, Unit 3) First, Next, Last — sandwich sequence
7. (Week 23, Unit 3) Helmet, gloves, hand-washing — safety rules
8. (Week 28, Unit 4) Cash's Cafe opens — first dramatic play day
9. (Week 32, Unit 4) Take turns: shopkeeper and customer
10. (Week 36, Unit 4) Family Visit Day — show and tell

Lesson 1 — Who helped you today?

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 25 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Helpers all around us
Cash video tie-in: V1 — "Cash Says Hi"



Objectives

- Name one helper a child saw today.
- Tell one thing that helper did.

Standards

- **Jump$tart Standard 3, Benchmark 4-1:** Identify reasons people work.
- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify goods and services people in the community produce.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 (1:30) on a screen, or printed picture cards if no screen.
- A circle-time rug.
- Class chart paper and a thick marker.
- Photos of three helpers (bus driver, librarian, cook). Use real photos from the school where possible.

Vocabulary

- **helper** — someone who does a job that helps us.
- **business** — a place or person that helps people.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Children gather on the rug. Show a photo of the school bus driver. Ask, "Who is this? What do they do?" Take 3–4 answers. Affirm the helper word: "Yes — the bus driver is a helper."

Mini-lesson — 4 min. Play Cash Video #1. Cash says hi, points to a mail carrier, points to a librarian, says "these are helpers. Helpers do

jobs. Helpers are a kind of business." Pause the video at the end. Ask, "Who did Cash see?" Children point and name.

Activity — 12 min. "Who helped you today?" Each child names one helper they saw before they came to school or in school today. Acceptable: bus driver, crossing guard, breakfast cook, secretary, custodian, teacher, librarian, big sibling who tied a shoe. Write each on the chart paper next to a quick stick figure. Repeat the helper's job: "What did they do?" Capture in 2–3 words next to the name.

Close — 6 min. Read the class chart back together, like a poem. "The bus driver drove. The cook cooked. The librarian read." End with the year's first phrase: "Helpers help. Notice, notice, notice." Children repeat the phrase three times.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Pair with a child who shares a home language for partner-naming. Allow a child to point at a photo instead of saying the English word; the teacher names it warmly.
- **IEP/504.** A child who cannot speak in front of the group may whisper to the teacher who then writes it on the chart. Picture cards available for non-speaking children to point.
- **Advanced.** Push: "Tell me one MORE thing the helper did." Add their second answer in parentheses on the chart.

Assessment

On the **Helper Noticing Checklist**, mark each child as: named a helper today (Y/N), told what the helper did (Y/N). No grades. Just a snapshot.

Lesson 2 — The Helpers Wall

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Helpers all around us

Objectives

- Draw or place a photo of one community helper on the class wall.
- Tell a partner one way that helper helps people.

Standards

- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Identify characters, settings, and major events.
- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify goods and services in the community.

Materials

- A blank bulletin board labeled **HELPERS**.
- Pre-cut paper squares (5x5 inches), one per child.
- Crayons, markers.
- Optional: photos of local helpers (mail carrier, firefighter, dentist, pet groomer, grocery cashier).

Vocabulary

- **community** — the place where you live and the people in it.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Show three photos of helpers. Ask, "What do they do?" One-word answers welcome.

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Show the blank bulletin board. "This is our Helpers Wall. We will fill it up all year. Today, you draw one helper you have seen." Demonstrate by drawing a stick-figure mail carrier on a sample square.

Activity — 17 min. Each child draws one helper on a square. Walk and confer. Ask quietly: "Who is this? What do they do?" Write the child's words at the bottom of their square in the teacher's hand (kindergartners often can't write yet — that's fine). Children add their square to the wall. The teacher names each one as it goes up: "Mia drew a librarian. The librarian helps us find books."

Close — 5 min. Stand in front of the wall. Read 4–5 squares aloud. Cheer the wall (one clap each). Say the phrase: "Helpers help. Notice, notice, notice."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Allow drawing-only with no caption. The picture is the language.

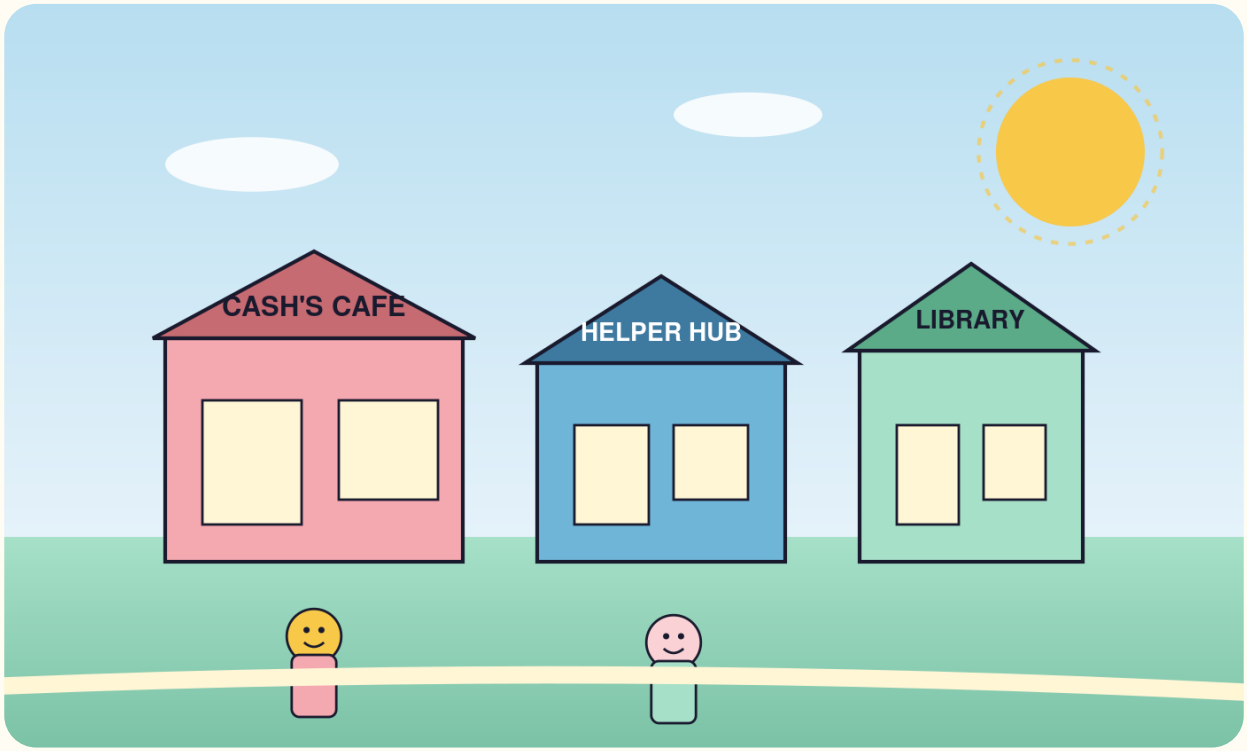
- **IEP/504.** Pre-printed photo stickers for children who cannot draw. They peel and place.
- **Advanced.** Add a second square — "a helper you've never seen but think exists." (e.g., a beekeeper, a train conductor.)

Assessment

On the checklist, mark: contributed a square (Y/N), named the helper out loud (Y/N).

Lesson 3 — Match the sign to the helper

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 25 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Helpers all around us



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

Objectives

- Match a business sign or logo to what the business does.
- Tell what the helper at that business does.

Standards

- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify goods and services.
- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Major events of a story (the "story" of a business).

Materials

- Card pairs: pizza-shop sign + a slice of pizza; dentist sign with tooth + a smile with brushed teeth; fire station + a firefighter; library + a stack of books; grocery store + a banana.
- Pocket chart or floor space.

Vocabulary

- **sign** — a picture that tells you what a place is.

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Hold up the pizza sign card. "What's this place?" Children call out. "How did you know?" Children answer: "the pizza on the sign!"

Mini-lesson — 4 min. "Signs help us. Signs tell us what a place does. We can read signs even before we can read words." Show all five sign cards quickly. Children name them.

Activity — 13 min. Two-card matching game. Lay sign cards on one side, action cards (pizza slice, smile, firefighter, books, banana) on the other. Children take turns picking one of each and saying the match: "Pizza shop. They sell pizza. The pizza shop helper makes the pizza." Class repeats the helper sentence with each match.

Close — 5 min. Whole-class chant: "Pizza shop, pizza. Library, books. Dentist, smile. Firefighter, fire." Hand motions encouraged.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Picture-only matching is fully fine; speech is bonus, not required.
- **IEP/504.** Pair child with a peer-helper for the matching turn.
- **Advanced.** Add an open-ended sign: a sign with just a name (e.g., "Joe's") and ask, "what could Joe's be?" Accept all reasonable guesses.

Assessment

Checklist: matched 3+ signs correctly (Y/N), named the helper at one business (Y/N).

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

Lesson 4 — Meet the four coins

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Coins and counting
Cash video tie-in: V3 — "The Four Coins"

Objectives

- Name a penny, a nickel, a dime, and a quarter.

- Pick the named coin out of a group.

Standards

- **CCSS-Math K.MD.A.2:** Compare two objects with a measurable attribute.
- **CCSS-Math K.CC.B.4:** Understand counting and cardinality.

Materials

- Cash Video #3.
- Coin cards (laminated): 6 of each of the four coins.
- A small jar of real coins for closing demo (teacher-handled, supervised).
- A "coin parking lot" mat with four labeled circles: penny, nickel, dime, quarter.

Vocabulary

- **penny, nickel, dime, quarter, coin.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Hold up the four coin cards one at a time. Children watch. No naming yet.

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Play Cash V3. Cash names each coin: "Penny. Penny is brown. Penny is one cent." Pause after each. Children echo. "Nickel. Nickel is silver. Nickel is bigger than a penny." And so on.

Activity — 17 min. Coin parking lot. Each child gets a small handful of coin cards (mixed). They sort cards into the four circles on the mat. Teacher walks the room. As children finish, ask: "Show me a dime." They point or pick up. "Show me a quarter." Repeat with the names.

Close — 5 min. Hold up the real coin jar, supervised. Tip out one of each. Children name them, in chorus, as the teacher points. End the block with hand-washing.

Differentiation

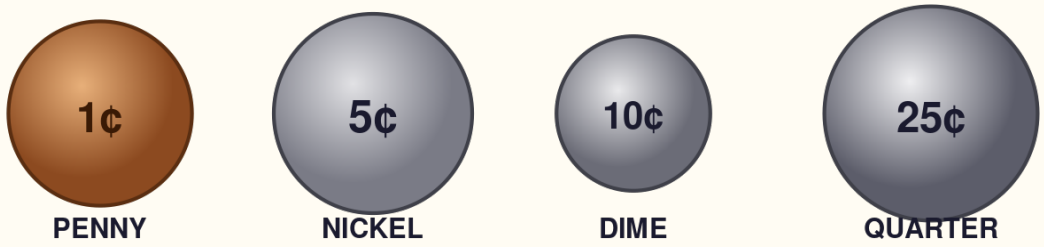
- **ELL.** Color and size cues are universal. "Brown — penny. Big silver — quarter."
- **IEP/504.** Reduce the field — sort only two coins at first (penny vs. quarter, then add nickel, then dime). Build up.
- **Advanced.** Add the question: "Which one looks the smallest? Which one looks the biggest?" Accept observation; the surprise that the dime is small but worth more is fine to surface (next lesson).

Assessment

Checklist: correctly named all four coins (Y/N), sorted at least 3 of 4 correctly (Y/N).

Lesson 5 — Which coin is more?

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 25 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Coins and counting



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

Objectives

- Pick the coin that is worth more in a pair.
- Tell why (with the value or with "I remember").

Standards

- **CCSS-Math K.CC.B.4 / K.MD.A.2:** Counting, comparing.
- **Jump$tart Standard 1, Benchmark 4-1:** Distinguish between needs and wants (light tie-in: more vs. less).

Materials

- Coin cards.
- A "More" arrow card and a "Less" arrow card.

Vocabulary

- **more, less, worth.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Hold up a penny card and a quarter card. "Which one is worth more?" Take guesses. Tell them: "The quarter. A quarter is worth twenty-five. A penny is worth one." Children repeat: "Quarter is more."

Mini-lesson — 4 min. Show the four coin values on a chart with little dots: penny = 1 dot, nickel = 5 dots, dime = 10 dots, quarter = 25 dots. "More dots, more worth." Touch each. Children touch their fingers along.

Activity — 13 min. Pair-up game. Each child draws two coin cards. They place the bigger-worth coin under the "More" arrow and the smaller under the "Less" arrow. They tell a partner: "This one is more because it has more dots." Three rounds. Teacher confers with 4–5 children.

Close — 5 min. Whole-class chant: "Quarter, more than dime. Dime, more than nickel. Nickel, more than penny. Penny is one." Repeat twice.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Use the dot chart as the language. Dots speak across language.

- **IEP/504.** Limit pairs to penny-vs-quarter only; build to mixed pairs over the week.
- **Advanced.** Show three coins; pick the one that is most. Optional: "how much altogether?" (skip-count by 5s if dimes and nickels.)

Assessment

Checklist: picked the more-valuable coin in 4 of 5 pairs (Y/N).

Lesson 6 — First, Next, Last (sandwich sequence)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Putting things in order
Cash video tie-in: V5 — "First, Next, Last"

Objectives

- Put three pictures of "making a sandwich" in the right order.
- Tell a partner what comes first, next, and last.

Standards

- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Sequence events.
- **CCSS-Math K.CC.B.4:** Counting (first, second, third).

Materials

- Cash Video #5.

- Three-picture sets per child (cut-apart cards): bread on plate, peanut butter on bread, sandwich done.
- A "First / Next / Last" mat.

Vocabulary

- **first, next, last, in order.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Show the three sandwich cards in scrambled order. "Is this right?" Children laugh. "What's wrong?"

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Play Cash V5. Cash says: "Things happen in order. First. Next. Last." Cash demonstrates with a sandwich. Children echo "first, next, last" with hand motions (left, middle, right).

Activity — 17 min. Each child receives a 3-card set. They place the cards on the First/Next/Last mat. Teacher walks. Each child whispers their order to a partner, then to the teacher: "First, the bread. Next, the peanut butter. Last, the sandwich."

Close — 5 min. A "helper sequence" extension. Show three cards: a firefighter putting on a helmet, a firefighter on the truck, a firefighter helping. Class agrees together: "First, helmet. Next, truck. Last, help." End: "Helpers do it in order."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Hand motions (left, middle, right) carry the meaning across language.
- **IEP/504.** Two-card version (first, last) for children who need a smaller field.
- **Advanced.** Four-card sequences (bread, jelly, peanut butter, sandwich). Or a five-step shoe-tying card.

Assessment

Checklist: sequenced 3 cards correctly (Y/N), named first/next/last out loud (Y/N).

Lesson 7 — Helmet, gloves, hand-washing

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 25 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Putting things in order

Objectives

- Name one safety rule a worker follows.
- Tell why that rule matters.

Standards

- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own safety and emotions.

- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify community workers.

Materials

- Picture cards: a construction worker with a helmet, a doctor with gloves, a cook washing hands, a crossing guard with a stop sign.
- Optional read-aloud: Officer Buckle and Gloria.

Vocabulary

- **safety rule, helmet, gloves, hand-washing.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Show the helmet card. "Why does she wear this?" Children answer: "so her head is safe."

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Read 1–2 pages of Officer Buckle and Gloria (or similar). Pause and ask, "What's one safety rule we just heard?" Capture on chart paper.

Activity — 12 min. Card-by-card walk-through. For each helper card, ask: "What's their safety rule? Why?" Children give one-word answers. Affirm: "Yes — the cook washes hands so the food is safe. The doctor wears gloves so the germs stay away."

Close — 5 min. "Tell a partner one safety rule a helper follows. And why." Two volunteers share with the whole class. End with the chant: "Safe helper. Safe people. Safe job."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Pair with a peer; the picture is the language.
- **IEP/504.** Provide a child a chosen rule on a card; they hold it and say the one rule on it.
- **Advanced.** Add: "Have you ever seen a helper NOT follow their rule? What happened?" (Accept careful answers; do not press.)

Assessment

Checklist: named one safety rule (Y/N), told why it matters (Y/N).

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Lesson 8 — Cash's Cafe opens

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Cash's Cafe (Capstone dramatic play) **Cash video tie-in:** V7 — "Welcome to Cash's Cafe"

Objectives

- Take a turn as shopkeeper or customer.
- Use kind words (please, thank you).

Standards

- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation and turn-taking.
- **Jump$tart Standard 3, Benchmark 4-1:** Reasons people work.

Materials

- Cash Video #7.
- Cafe corner setup: a small table, two chairs, paper aprons (4–6), pretend food (felt or paper) — pretzels, apples, cookies, milk cartons.
- Pretend coin cards.
- An OPEN/CLOSED sign on a stick.

Vocabulary

- **shopkeeper, customer, kind words.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Show the cafe corner. "This is Cash's Cafe! What do you see?"

Mini-lesson — 5 min. Play Cash V7. Cash explains: "At Cash's Cafe, you take turns. One is the shopkeeper. One is the customer. The shopkeeper says: 'How can I help you?' The customer says: 'Please, may I have a pretzel?' We use kind words." Children echo.

Activity — 17 min. First turn: pick 2 children. One shopkeeper, one customer. Teacher coaches the lines. Other children watch. Trade.

Trade again. Each round 2 minutes. Run 4–5 rounds. Children clap softly between rounds.

Close — 5 min. "What kind word did you hear today?" Children call out: "please. thank you. you're welcome." Hang the OPEN/CLOSED sign on the cafe corner. "Cash's Cafe is OPEN now. We will visit it again."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence frames on a card the child holds: "Please, may I have ___?" "Thank you."
- **IEP/504.** Allow non-verbal trades — the child can point to the food and nod. Coach the partner to use the kind words on their behalf.
- **Advanced.** Add a third role: the helper who tidies up between customers (LRCI strand). Expand the menu after Week 30.

Assessment

Checklist: took at least one turn (Y/N), used a kind word (please/thank you) (Y/N).

Lesson 9 — Take turns: shopkeeper and customer

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Cash's Cafe

Objectives

- Trade roles between shopkeeper and customer.
- Finish a small classroom job (pass out napkins, restock the menu).

Standards

- **CASEL Relationship Skills.**
- **Jump$tart Standard 3, Benchmark 4-1.**

Materials

- Cafe corner.
- Small napkin pile (paper).
- A "JOBS" chart with 3 jobs: shopkeeper, customer, napkin helper.
- A timer (optional).

Vocabulary

- **take turns, finish.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. "Today everyone tries each job. Three jobs. We rotate." Show the JOBS chart.

Mini-lesson — 4 min. Demonstrate one full cycle. Teacher plays customer; a student plays shopkeeper; another student plays napkin helper. Three lines: "Please may I have a cookie?" (customer) "Yes, here is your cookie." (shopkeeper) "Here is your napkin." (helper).

Activity — 18 min. Groups of 3. Rotate every 3 minutes. Teacher rings the timer (or claps three times) to signal the rotation. Each child should land in each role at least once.

Close — 5 min. "Which job did you like best?" Quick-call answers. "Which job was hardest?" Accept. End with the phrase: "Take turns. Use kind words. Finish the job."

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Sentence-frame cards stay available. Hand motions accompany words.
- **IEP/504.** A child can stay in one role for the full block if rotation overwhelms. Note on the checklist.
- **Advanced.** Add a fourth role: "manager" who decides what is on today's menu (1 child per round). Coach against bossiness; reframe as deciding for the team.

Assessment

Checklist: took at least 2 different roles (Y/N), finished the napkin job (Y/N), used kind words (Y/N).

Lesson 10 — Family Visit Day (Showcase)

Grade band: K-2 **Time:** 30 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Cash's Cafe (Capstone — Family Visit Day) **Cash video tie-in:** V8 — "Tell a Grown-up What You Saw"

Objectives

- Tell a grown-up about one helper noticed in the community.
- Show a grown-up the Cash's Cafe corner and play one round.

Standards

- **C3 D2.Eco.2.K-2:** Identify goods and services in the community.
- **CCSS-ELA RL.K.3:** Describe events.

Materials

- The Helpers Wall (full).
- The Cash's Cafe corner (open).
- A "Helper of the Year" choosing card per child (drawn earlier in the week).
- A small badge sticker for each child after they share.

Vocabulary

- **show, tell.**

Procedure

Warm-up — 3 min. Greet families in a circle. Children sit, families stand behind. Cash V8 plays: Cash welcomes the families and says, "the children have been noticing helpers all year. Now they will tell you what they saw with their eyes."

Mini-lesson — 4 min. Teacher demonstrates with one volunteer child: "This is the helper I noticed. They are a [helper]. They [what they did]." The grown-up says: "Thank you for telling me."

Activity — 18 min. Children rotate. Each child finds their grown-up (or a partner grown-up if their family couldn't come — buddied with a teacher or another child's family). They walk to the Helpers Wall and show their square. They visit Cash's Cafe and play one round (child as shopkeeper, grown-up as customer). After each child shares, the teacher hands them a small badge.

Close — 5 min. Whole-class farewell. "Helpers help. Notice, notice, notice. We saw a lot of helpers this year." Children wave to the families.

Differentiation

- **ELL.** Family members may speak any language with their child. Encourage. The picture and the cafe play carry the meaning.
- **IEP/504.** Children who freeze in front of grown-ups can have the teacher narrate while the child points. Counts as completed.

- **Advanced.** A child may share two helpers, or take the grown-up on a walking tour of the Helpers Wall and narrate.

Assessment

Final checklist (year-end): named at least one helper (Y/N), played a Cash's Cafe round (Y/N), used kind words (Y/N). This is the year's culminating observation. Add to the cumulative folder.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Notes on the lessons not shown

The remaining ~26 weekly blocks recycle these patterns:

- **Helpers Wall maintenance.** Weekly add 1–2 new helpers. Read the wall together.
- **Coin recognition routine.** A 5-minute "show me a [coin]" ritual on Tuesdays after Unit 2 starts.
- **Sequence-of-the-week.** A new 3-card sequence each Wednesday after Unit 3 starts (hand-washing, brushing teeth, packing a backpack, planting a seed, etc.).

- **Cafe time.** Once Unit 4 begins, a 15-minute cafe rotation runs twice a week.
- **Cash video viewings.** Each of the eight Cash videos lands once. Re-watch one short Cash video per week thereafter as a brain-break.

Teachers may sub in any picture book the school library has that fits the week's theme. Anchor texts in the Curriculum Book are a starting list, not a required list.

Year-end teacher reflection (2 questions)

After the Family Visit Day, the teacher writes 2–3 sentences answering:

- Which lesson did the children carry the most? (Use the checklist data.)
- What would I change for next year? (One specific change.)

This is the program's smallest LRCI move — modeling for ourselves the same "what would I change?" question we'll ask of every grade after this one.

Unit-by-unit overviews

These short overviews give the teacher the shape of each unit at a glance. The 10 sampled lessons above cover the high points; the unit overviews fill in the weeks between.

Unit 1 — Helpers all around us (Weeks 1–9)

Spine. Build the noticing habit. Build the Helpers Wall. Children should be able to name 3 community helpers and tell what each one does by Week 9.

Daily routine (5–10 minutes). Begin every Cash to Company block with the question "Who helped you today?" Take 3–5 answers. Add a square to the wall on Tuesdays.

Read-alouds (one per week). Pick from the anchor list. Re-read favorites. Read slowly. Pause and ask, "who helps in this story?"

Weeks 1–3. Bus driver, librarian, school cook. Helpers right here in our school. **Weeks 4–6.** Mail carrier, firefighter, dentist, pet groomer. Helpers in our neighborhood. **Weeks 7–9.** Build to "name three helpers and tell what they do" as the unit's small assessment. The Helpers Wall should be full.

Cash videos in this unit. V1 (Cash Says Hi — Week 1), V2 (What Did the Helper Do? — Week 5).

Unit 2 — Coins and counting (Weeks 10–18)

Spine. Name the four coins. Tell which is more. Children should be able to point to each coin on cue and pick the more-valuable one in a pair by Week 18.

Daily routine. Add a 3-minute coin moment to the start of each block: "show me a [coin]." Children point at the coin chart on the wall.

Weeks 10–12. Penny, then nickel. Just two. Sort and name. **Weeks 13–14.** Add the dime. The trick of the dime: small, but worth more than the bigger nickel. Children find this funny — let them. **Weeks 15–16.** Add the quarter. Big. Worth twenty-five. **Weeks 17–18.** The "which is more?" game in pairs. Repeat. Repeat. Repeat.

Cash videos in this unit. V3 (The Four Coins — Week 10), V4 (Which Coin Is More? — Week 14).

Unit 3 — Putting things in order (Weeks 19–27)

Spine. Sequence three pictures. Name first / next / last. Tell one safety rule a worker follows.

Daily routine. A "sequence-of-the-week" card sits on the rug. Children put it in order at arrival.

Weeks 19–21. Sandwich, hand-washing, brushing teeth. **Weeks 22–24.** Helpers in order: firefighter (helmet, truck, help), mail carrier (bag, walk, deliver), dentist (gloves, tools, smile). **Weeks 25–27.** Safety rules. Helmet, gloves, hand-washing, walk don't run. Why each rule matters.

Cash videos in this unit. V5 (First, Next, Last — Week 19), V6 (Safe Helper, Safe Job — Week 25).

Unit 4 — Cash's Cafe (Weeks 28–36)

Spine. Take turns as shopkeeper, customer, and napkin helper. Use kind words. Finish a small classroom job. Family Visit Day at the end.

Daily routine. Cash's Cafe runs twice a week, 15 minutes each session. Three groups of 3 children rotate through. The rest of the class watches and cheers softly.

Weeks 28–30. Cafe opens. Two roles: shopkeeper and customer. Coach the kind words. **Weeks 31–33.** Add the third role: napkin helper. Practice rotating. **Weeks 34–35.** Children prepare a "Helper of the Year" drawing for the Family Visit Day. **Week 36.** Family Visit Day.

Cash videos in this unit. V7 (Welcome to Cash's Cafe — Week 28), V8 (Tell a Grown-up What You Saw — Week 36).

A short FAQ for first-time K teachers

My class can't sit still for 30 minutes. What do I cut? Cut the close. Keep the warm-up, mini-lesson, and activity. The activity is the lesson. The chant at the end is nice but not essential.

The children keep saying "my mom" when I ask about helpers. Is that wrong? No. A parent is a helper. Receive it warmly. Then ask, "who helped you today outside your house?"

One child won't take a turn at Cash's Cafe. Don't push. Let them watch for the first two cafe sessions. Many will join in the third or fourth round. If they never join, partner them with a peer; the peer can play and the watching child can hold the OPEN sign. Counts as participation.

How do I assess without grading? The class checklist is the assessment. Mark Y/N. Watch for trends. If half the class is N on coin naming after Week 14, slow down and re-teach.

The dramatic play gets loud and silly. That's the work. Kindergartners learn through play. As long as kind words are happening and turns are real, the noise is fine.

A family member can't come for the Family Visit Day. Pair the child with a teacher, paraprofessional, or another family. The point is telling a grown-up — the specific grown-up matters less than the telling.

A child uses unkind words at Cash's Cafe. Pause the play. Restate the rule: "At Cash's Cafe, we use kind words. Please. Thank you. You're welcome." Have the child try again. Most kindergartners will self-correct on the second try.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

How to use the class checklist (assessment crib sheet)

The class checklist is one page. Down the left: every child's name. Across the top: the year's eight strand outcomes, written in kid-friendly form:

1. Names 3 helpers and what they do.
2. Names a problem and a helper for it.
3. Names penny, nickel, dime, quarter; picks the more-valuable in a pair.
4. Matches a sign to what a place does.
5. Sequences 3 pictures correctly.
6. Takes turns at Cash's Cafe with kind words.
7. Names one safety rule and why.
8. Finishes the napkin job.

Mark Y when you see a child do it. No partial credit at K. No grades. The checklist is for the teacher's planning and for the year-end family

conference. By June, every child should have most boxes checked. If a box is empty for 4+ children, that's the lesson to repeat.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Common Misconceptions and classroom-tested moves

Added in the deep-think review pass. Print this page and tape it inside the front cover of your Teacher Guide — it earns its real estate.

Common Misconceptions (K-band, picture-first)

Kid belief	What's actually true	How to coach (in K voice)
"The dime is small. So it's worth less."	The dime is worth 10. The penny is worth 1. Size and value are not the same.	Hold up the two coins. Touch the dots on the chart. "Small. But more dots." Repeat across the week.
"Mom's job is not a business."	Most jobs are part of a business that helps people.	"Does Mom help people?" Children say yes. "That helps a business help people too." No probing about pay.
"A helper has to wear a uniform."	Helpers are everyone who does a job that helps. Aprons, scrubs, no-uniform — all helpers.	Show three helpers without uniforms (a tutor, a babysitter, a dog walker). "All helpers."
"The bigger pile of coins is more money."	Five pennies is less than one quarter. Count the dots, not the pile.	Lay out five pennies and one quarter. Touch dots. "Quarter has more dots. Quarter is more."
"If I do a job once, the job is done forever."	A job done well is done again the next day. Helpers come back.	"The cook makes lunch. Yesterday and today and tomorrow." Use the year's calendar.

Classroom-tested move sets (when students freeze or fight)

If a child says "I can't think of a helper": point at the door. "Who walked you to your seat? That's a helper." Then walk to the chart and write that helper. Done.

If two children both want to be the shopkeeper: add a third role on the spot — the "sign-keeper" who holds the OPEN sign. Three roles, all important. Rotate every 2 minutes.

If a child gets stuck on coin sort after Lesson 5: drop to two coins (penny vs. quarter only) for one whole session. Add nickel next session, dime the session after. Most children get there by Week 14.

If a child cries during dramatic play: stop the play. "Are you the customer right now? It's pretend. We can stop. Do you want to be the helper instead?" Validate the feeling; offer a different role. Most children re-enter within 90 seconds.

If a family asks "is this socioeconomics?": "It's noticing helpers. We don't talk about how much things cost or who has what. We notice who helps." This is the line. Hold it warmly.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Kindergarten)

Common kid-belief	Reality	Coaching move
"The dime is small, so it must be worth less than the nickel."	A dime is worth 10¢ even though it is smaller than a nickel (which is 5¢).	Show coins side by side. Have students stack 10 pennies next to 1 dime. Say: "Same value. Different size." Repeat with quarter (25¢) vs. nickel (5¢).
"Helpers do their job for free."	Helpers (workers, business owners) get paid for their work. The customer pays so the helper can buy what they need.	Show the snack bar story: Maya pays the snack bar; the snack bar helper uses that money to buy more snacks for tomorrow. Repeat: "Helpers help. People pay. People get paid."
"If I cant see how it works, it isnt real work."	Some helpers do invisible work (planning, ordering, cleaning before customers arrive).	After Cashs Cafe, ask: "Who set out the napkins before we got here?" Affirm invisible work counts.
"Money on a sign is just decoration."	The price on a sign tells the customer how much to pay.	At Cashs Cafe, point to the price sign. Have one student be the customer who reads the price aloud and counts the right coins.

CASH

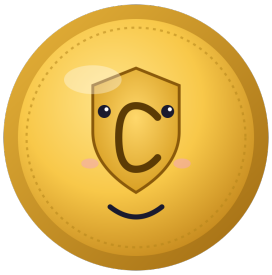
Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Kindergarten)

Named classroom moves for the most-common K stuck points:

- **Stuck on coin sort after Lesson 5.** Say: "Lets sort by what its worth, not by how big it is." Hand the student two pennies and one dime. Say: "These two pennies = 2 cents. This dime = 10 cents. Which is worth more?" Repeat with their hands.
- **Wont take turns in dramatic play.** Say: "In a business, helpers and customers both matter. Lets switch — youre the helper for one minute, then youre the customer for one minute." Use a visible timer.
- **Names a job that isnt a business** ("my mom takes me to school"). Say: "Some jobs are inside the family — like taking care of you. Some jobs are businesses, where someone pays for the help. Both matter. Today were noticing the businesses."
- **Refuses to share a Cashs Cafe job.** Say: "You can pick the job you want. Lets find one." Offer 3 picture cards (passing napkins, taking orders, counting coins). Let student point.

- **Cries when their build doesnt look "right."** Say: "Helpers try things. Helpers also fix things. Lets fix one part of yours." Pick the smallest fixable thing. Affirm the fix.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade K